Padma went on to reveal that Nalini had eloped with her lover Das, alias Murugan, who was also an LTTE cadre. The LTTE operative Koneswaran had mentioned Murugan earlier. Verma abruptly stopped Padma and turned to Bhagyanathan. He could not feign ignorance any more. Ragothaman asked the female staff to shift Padma to another room. The interrogation of Bhagyanathan was to continue. He finally opened his mouth. He said the kurta-pyjama-clad man was Sivarasan—the LTTE cadre with one eye. Bhagyanathan confirmed what the SIT had learnt from Koneswaran, who was earlier arrested by the Q Branch. What about the various aliases such as Sivarajan, Shivarajah and Raghuvaran? Bhagyanathan confirmed that all of them belonged to just one person—one-eyed Sivarasan. Bhagyanathan was another big breakthrough in the investigation.[4]

The questioning of Bhagyanathan continued till ten o'clock the next morning. He confessed that the human bomb was Dhanu and her female companion in the photograph was Subha. Both the women were members of the suicide squad of the LTTE called the 'Black Tigress'. He corroborated the revelation made by Koneswaran on Sivarasan's role in the assassination of Padmanabha—Sivarasan had masterminded it and carried it out with the help of his deputy, Santhan. Bhagyanathan's claim confirmed Raju's and Kanth's earlier suspicions that both the assassinations were the handiwork of the same group. Bhagyanathan confessed that Sivarasan was the mastermind behind the Rajiv Gandhi assassination as well and that his main assistant was Murugan alias Das. His sister Nalini and Murugan had escaped soon after the Q Branch had met Nalini in her office in Adyar. The Q Branch's reluctance in taking Nalini in for questioning baffled the SIT. After all, her name and telephone number had been found in possession of an LTTE operative who knew Sivarasan, Murugan and other members of the Tigers' hit squad.[5]

By the time Bhagyanathan's interrogation ended, both Verma and Ragothaman looked exhausted. They needed a quick shower before they got back to Bhagyanathan for further interrogation. They left instructions with the staff to not allow Bhagyanathan any rest while they were gone. Any